



Britain and Northern Ireland. **Great Britain**, then, refers to the island consisting of three somewhat independent regions: Scotland, Wales, and **England**. While the Irish, Scottish, and Welsh have distinctive

national customs, it is harder to pick out the elements of a specifically English identity. It may be fairest to say that the English people form a **patchwork** of identities, samples of which are explored below.



MORRIS DANCERS

Historically an important part of annual springtime festivities, Morris dancers wear bells on their feet and leap athletically to lively folk music while waving sticks or handkerchiefs.



TRADITIONAL PUBS

English pubs are a national institution and a mainstay of English social life. They vary greatly in style ranging from quaint, low-ceilinged timbered networks of rooms, to chic wallpapered and chandeliered Victorian pubs, to beer gardens popular with families. English law insists they close at 11pm, shortly after calling for "last orders."

UNIVERSITY TOWN

World-famous (along with Oxford) for its university founded in 1209, Cambridge is still dominated by student life. There are 31 colleges where students live and under whose care they are while at the university. Here, a punt (a flat bottomed boat) travels along the Cam River past St. John's College.



CARNIVAL!

London's Notting Hill Carnival has its origins in the West Indies. Trinidadian immigrants organized the first Carnival in 1964. Gradually it evolved from a celebration of black culture to a mainstream, multiracial event, a highlight of London's calendar. With one million participants, it has outgrown its route and may soon relocate.



The sculpture's location by the A1 highway means it is seen by 33 million people every year.



ANGEL OF THE NORTH

Erected in Gateshead in the northeast of England in 1998 this is the largest sculpture in Britain. Its wingspan is 175 ft (54 m), almost that of a jumbo jet.